Abdullah Al Zahid

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Talent Acquisition
GO & UP Operational Readiness & Performance
Metrolinx, Toronto, ON

Re: Operational Readiness Specialist

Dear Hiring Manager,

I would like to apply for the Operational Readiness Specialist position in the GO & UP Operational Readiness & Performance division. I worked at Metrolinx in 2023 as a Transportation Planner in Service Design, and since January 2024 I have been an Assistant Planner in Transportation Planning at the City of Toronto. Readiness is about knowing what a change will do to the operation before it reaches service, and that was the purpose of my work in Service Design.

There I ran OpenTrack simulations of GO rail services to establish what proposed operating and infrastructure changes would do to run times, reliability and recovery before they were taken forward, and assessed the service effect of temporary and permanent slow orders. I worked with schedulers, operations staff and engineers on service design decisions and presented the evidence behind them. I also set up a command line workflow that pre-simulated slow orders in batches, cutting turnaround on scenario requests from days to hours, and built the Crew Variance Tool, a Python application that read large JSON operations files and summarised speed profiles and run-time variance across subdivisions.

At Mott MacDonald I ran Synchro traffic simulations to estimate how Ontario Line construction staging and road closures would affect surrounding streets. At the City I review development applications and the studies filed with them against standards, recommend conditions where something is missing, and write the briefing notes and presentations that carry findings to managers in other divisions.

I should be straightforward about the gaps. I have not worked in operational readiness or commissioning, reviewed commissioning documentation, or given functional leadership to a team of coordinators. My review work has been of transportation studies and development submissions rather than detailed construction drawings, though I work in AutoCAD and Civil 3D, and I am not registered with PEO, which the posting lists as an asset.

Thank you for considering my application.

Sincerely,

Abdullah Al Zahid

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